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Year: 1st Year
Course Code: CSE0001
Course Title: Digital Literacy
Submission Date: 28/03/2026

INTRODUCTION

Digital literacy is an essential skill in today's technology-driven world. Students must understand how to use digital tools effectively, communicate responsibly online, and stay safe from cyber threats. This project was completed as part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course to develop practical knowledge about digital platforms and responsible internet usage. The project includes five tasks that focus on different aspects of digital literacy such as creating an awareness infographic, building a professional digital portfolio, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, learning professional email communication, and understanding cybercrime awareness. Through these activities, I gained experience using important digital tools such as GitHub, LinkedIn, Google Forms, and coding practice platforms. This project helped me improve my digital skills and understand how technology can be used safely and productively in academic and professional environments.

TASK 1

In Task 1, I created a digital literacy awareness infographic to explain the importance of digital skills for students. The infographic was designed using the online design platform Canva, which provides templates and design tools to create visual content easily. The infographic included important topics such as the meaning of digital literacy, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette. The aim of the design was to present information in a clear and visually appealing way so that students can quickly understand the concept of digital literacy. I used icons, colors, and short points to make the infographic simple and easy to read. One interesting part of this task was learning how to present information visually rather than through long text. The main challenge I faced was selecting the most important information while keeping the design simple. This activity helped me understand how visual communication can be used to spread awareness about digital literacy among students.

TASK 2

In Task 2, I created a professional digital portfolio by setting up accounts on platforms such as GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. GitHub is a platform used by developers to store, manage, and share coding projects. It helps programmers collaborate with others and maintain version control of their work. LinkedIn is a professional networking platform where students can create profiles to showcase their education, skills, and achievements. It helps connect with professionals, recruiters, and organizations. Kaggle is widely used in the field of data science for learning data analysis, participating in competitions, and exploring datasets. Creating these profiles helped me understand the importance of maintaining a professional online presence. Over the next four years, I plan to upload my coding projects on GitHub, build professional connections on LinkedIn, and explore data science learning on Kaggle. This task helped me realize that building a digital portfolio early can be very beneficial for internships and future career opportunities.

TASK 3

In Task 3, I explored online platforms used for coding practice and collaboration. For the coding practice activity, I created an account on HackerRank and solved a beginner programming challenge. HackerRank provides various programming problems that help students practice coding skills and improve problem-solving abilities. Completing a simple challenge helped me understand how coding platforms work and how they can be used to practice programming regularly. In the second part of this task, I created a digital literacy awareness quiz using Google Forms. The quiz included five questions related to digital literacy, internet safety, and digital tools. I also submitted one response to generate a response sheet. This helped me understand how Google Forms can be used to collect data and conduct online quizzes or surveys. Overall, this task helped me learn about useful online platforms that support learning, coding practice, and collaboration among students.

TASK 4

In Task 4, I learned about professional digital communication. I wrote two formal emails: one requesting an extension for an assignment submission and another expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity. Writing these emails helped me understand the importance of using a clear subject line, polite language, and proper greetings and sign-offs in professional communication. I also created a social media do’s and don’ts checklist to promote responsible online behavior among students. Poor digital communication can create misunderstandings or leave a negative impression. For example, sending an email without a proper greeting or subject line may appear unprofessional. Using respectful language, clear communication, and appropriate etiquette can help students communicate effectively with professors, employers, and colleagues.

TASK 5

In Task 5, I researched cybercrime awareness by studying an example of online payment fraud. Online payment fraud occurs when criminals trick individuals into sharing sensitive information such as OTPs, bank details, or UPI credentials. While researching this topic, I was surprised to learn how easily people can become victims of cybercrime through fake messages, suspicious links, or fraudulent phone calls. Students and elderly individuals are often targeted because they may not be aware of digital security risks. This task helped me understand the importance of being cautious while using digital payment systems. As a result of this research, I have decided to follow safer online habits such as never sharing OTPs, verifying payment requests, and avoiding unknown links or QR codes.

CONCLUSION

This project helped me gain a deeper understanding of digital literacy and its importance in academic and professional life. Through the different tasks, I learned how to create digital content, build a professional digital presence, communicate effectively through emails, and understand cybercrime risks. The project also introduced me to useful platforms such as GitHub, LinkedIn, HackerRank, and Google Forms. These platforms will help me develop my technical and professional skills throughout my engineering studies. Overall, the project improved my awareness of responsible digital behavior and taught me how to use digital tools safely and effectively.

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